

# Stop Arguing and Start Cashing In on Open Source Specifications



APIs are the building blocks of modern software. Having a contract in place to build an API facilitates easier communication between the parties involved. But what happens when the format of the contract tends to increase arguments among team members? That's where open source specifications that define APIs come in, and spreadsheets don't help.

Open source, in simple terms, is defined as software where the copyright holder grants users the right to use, modify, and distribute the software and its source code to anyone, for any purpose. Despite open source specifications being one of the most critical components of the ecosystem, these are not talked of often. As a matter of fact, the specifications of software are what make it distinctive. These specifications are also discussed, debated on and argued about in development teams, but not much is written about them. Is there a way for teams to stop arguing about, and start cashing in on open source specifications?

Let's answer that question with a story!

## The loan app specifications

This story revolves around a team developing an app intended to help bank customers sign up for securing a loan at the click of a button. Sonali, a business analyst in the team, walks up and informs her colleagues that they need to build a feature that allows customers to apply for a loan, using a downstream customer application programming interface (API) exposed by the client. She asks the team about the time required to develop this feature.

Meera, who is an application developer in the team, comes in. She is really smart and does not commit